

— THE PROFIT COMPASS PRESENTS —

Medium Vault: How Course Funnels Builds **\$1,000/Month**

The quiet content-to-cash system that turns a handful of Medium articles into a course funnel that keeps selling while you sleep.

A PROFIT COMPASS PLAYBOOK

THE PROFIT COMPASS

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Medium Vault: How Course Funnels Builds \$1,000/Month

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— *The Profit Compass*

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INTRODUCTION

The Article That Never Stops Selling

Right now, somewhere on Medium, an article published eighteen months ago by someone who hasn't logged in for a year is still quietly sending strangers toward a \$47 course. No new writing. No new ads. Just one page, doing its job, on repeat.

That's the entire premise of this book. Not a hack, not a loophole — a structure. A "vault" article is any piece of content that keeps earning its keep long after you've stopped actively promoting it, because it's built on top of a platform that already has the audience, the search authority, and the trust that would normally take you years to build on your own domain.

Most people trying to make money from a course get the order backwards. They build the course first, then go looking for an audience, then panic when nobody shows up. The Medium Vault method flips that sequence: you use Medium's existing distribution to find the people who already have the problem, prove you can solve a sliver of it for free, and only then invite them into a paid course that solves the rest.

This isn't a get-rich-quick promise. It's a get-paid-steadily system — one built around a specific, achievable number: **\$1,000 a month**. Not because that's a ceiling, but because it's

the number where a side project stops being a hobby and starts being a real, repeatable business. Once you can produce \$1,000 a month on autopilot from a handful of vault articles, doubling and tripling it becomes a matter of volume, not a matter of luck.

Over the next six chapters, you'll learn exactly how the vault is built, how a single article is engineered to convert curious readers into paying students, and what the honest math behind \$1,000/month actually looks like — no inflated screenshots, no vague promises. Just a system you can start building today, one article at a time.

CHAPTER ONE

The Medium Vault Concept

What it is, and why it beats building a blog from zero

Every content creator faces the same cold-start problem: no audience, no search rankings, no trust — and building all three from a brand-new blog can take years. Medium removes that problem almost entirely. It's a publication with its own massive, built-in readership, its own internal recommendation engine, and search-engine authority so strong that a well-written article can rank on Google within days, not years.

A **vault** is simply an article you publish on Medium that is deliberately engineered to do two jobs at once: deliver real, standalone value to a reader searching for an answer, and quietly guide that same reader toward a free resource that starts your course funnel. You're not renting Medium's audience for a one-time visit — you're depositing an asset into an account that keeps paying interest.

Why Medium Instead of Your Own Blog?

A brand-new blog has to earn every visitor through ads, social media, or slow, patient SEO. Medium hands you a portion of its existing traffic simply by publishing well — through its "For You" feed, topic tags, email digests, and the platform's own domain authority. You still have to write something worth reading. You just don't have to build the stadium before you're allowed to play in it.

The Vault vs. the One-Off Post

Most writers publish, get a short burst of views, and move on. A vault article is written to keep working long after that burst fades — it targets a specific, evergreen search phrase, answers it thoroughly, and ends with a clear, low-friction next step. That's the difference between a diary entry and a business asset.

CASE STUDY — PRIYA'S FIRST VAULT ARTICLE

Priya, a freelance graphic designer, published a single Medium article titled "Why Your Freelance Portfolio Isn't Landing Clients." It was 1,400 words of genuinely useful advice, ending with a link to a free portfolio-review checklist.

Eight months later, that one article was still generating 300–500 views a month from Google and Medium's own search, feeding roughly 15–20 people a month into her email list — and three or four of them into her \$97 portfolio mini-course. She never boosted it, never ran an ad. She just wrote it once, correctly.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ Medium gives you access to an existing audience and search authority you'd otherwise spend years building on your own domain.
- ◆ A "vault" article is written to deliver real value and evergreen search relevance, not just a short burst of attention.
- ◆ The goal of a vault article is one clear next step — not ten links, not a hard sell, just one obvious door to walk through.
- ◆ One well-built vault article can keep producing leads for months, or years, without further work.

CHAPTER TWO

Setting Up Your Vault

Positioning, niche, and the reader's journey

Before you write a single article, you need three things decided: who exactly you're writing for, what single transformation your course delivers, and what journey a stranger takes to get from "curious reader" to "paying student." Skip this step and you'll end up with a pile of unrelated articles that don't add up to a business.

Pick One Promise, Not One Topic

A "topic" like productivity or marketing is too broad to build a vault around. A "promise" is specific: *"I'll show working parents how to batch a week of dinners in ninety minutes"* is a promise. Every article in your vault should serve that one promise from a different angle — not just be loosely related content.

The Reader Journey

Every reader who lands on a vault article moves through four stages, and your job is to design a gentle nudge at each one:



Fig. 1 — The four-stage reader journey your vault is designed to move people through.

- ✓ **Stranger → Reader:** They find your article through Google or Medium's feed, drawn in by a title that matches something they were already searching for.
- ✓ **Reader → Subscriber:** A genuinely useful free resource (checklist, template, mini-guide) convinces them to hand over their email.
- ✓ **Subscriber → Student:** A short, value-first email sequence builds trust and makes the course offer feel like the obvious next step, not a sales pitch.

CASE STUDY — ROHAN'S NICHE RESET

Rohan started writing broadly about "personal finance" and got scattered, low-converting traffic. He narrowed his promise to "helping first-year software engineers negotiate their first salary raise." His next three articles, all written for that one reader, out-converted his previous twenty combined.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ Build your vault around one specific promise to one specific reader, not a broad topic.
- ◆ Map the four-stage journey — Stranger, Reader, Subscriber, Student — before writing your first article.
- ◆ Every vault article should move a reader exactly one stage forward, never try to sell the course directly from a cold read.
- ◆ Narrowing your niche almost always increases conversion, even if it feels like it shrinks your audience.

Writing Articles That Convert

The anatomy of a vault entry that quietly sells

A vault article has a repeatable anatomy. It isn't formulaic in a lazy sense — it's structured the way a good conversation is structured, with a natural beginning, middle, and a door left open at the end.

The Five-Part Structure

- ✓ **The hook (first 2–3 lines):** A specific, relatable pain point or surprising fact that makes the reader think "this is written for me."
- ✓ **The proof:** A short story, statistic, or personal result that earns the right to be listened to — without turning into a resume.
- ✓ **The teaching:** The genuinely useful core of the article. This must stand alone as valuable even if the reader never clicks anything else.
- ✓ **The bridge:** One or two sentences connecting what you just taught to a bigger gap the article can't fully close — this is where the free resource is introduced.
- ✓ **The soft CTA:** A single, low-pressure link to the free resource — a checklist, template, or short guide — framed as a natural continuation, not a sales pitch.

A NOTE ON TONE

The best-converting vault articles never feel like an ad. They read like a knowledgeable friend sharing something useful, who happens to mention "I actually put together a free checklist for the next part of this if you want it." Subtlety converts better than urgency on a platform built for reading, not clicking.

Vault Stacking

One article is a lucky break. Five to ten articles, each targeting a different search phrase within your one promise and each linking to the same free resource, is a system. This is called **vault stacking** — every new article you publish adds another entry point into the same funnel, so your traffic sources compound instead of resetting to zero each time.

CASE STUDY — THE SIX-ARTICLE STACK

A career coach published six Medium articles over ten weeks, each answering a different interview-prep question, all linking to the same free "STAR Method Cheat Sheet." By week twelve, the six articles combined were sending over 60 email subscribers a month into her funnel — more than any single article could have produced alone.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ Follow the five-part structure: hook, proof, teaching, bridge, soft CTA.
- ◆ The teaching section must be valuable on its own — the free resource is a bonus, not a ransom.
- ◆ Keep the call-to-action soft and singular — one link, framed as help, not a pitch.
- ◆ Stack multiple articles around different search phrases that all funnel into the same free resource.

CHAPTER FOUR

Building the Course Funnel

From free value to a paid offer people want

The funnel is what turns vault traffic into vault income. It has three moving parts: the free resource that captures an email, the nurture sequence that builds trust, and the course offer itself.

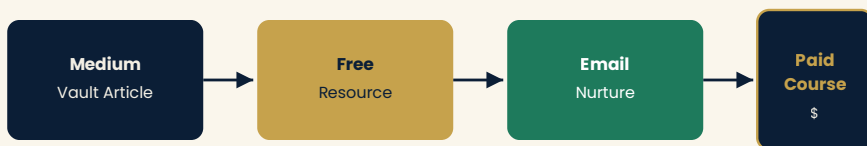


Fig. 2 — The complete Medium Vault funnel, from article to paid course.

The Free Resource

This is the "toll" a reader pays with their email to get something genuinely useful — a checklist, swipe file, template, or short guide that solves one small, specific problem completely. It should take less than ten minutes to consume and deliver a real win, not a teaser.

The Nurture Sequence

Four to six short emails, spaced two to three days apart, each delivering one useful idea before ever mentioning the course. The final email or two makes the offer directly — clearly, without apology, because by then the reader has already received real value three or four times over.

The Course Offer

Your course doesn't need to be an eight-module marathon. A tightly scoped course that takes someone from a well-defined "before" to a well-defined "after" in a few hours of content will out-convert a bloated one every time — and it's far faster to actually finish creating.

CASE STUDY — THE \$67 MICRO-COURSE

Instead of building a sprawling course, a nutrition coach built a single-purpose \$67 "7-Day Meal Prep Reset" — five short videos and a done-for-you shopping list. Because it was so tightly scoped, she finished creating it in one weekend, and its narrow promise made the sales page almost write itself.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ The funnel has three parts: free resource, nurture sequence, paid course — each with one clear job.
- ◆ The free resource must deliver a complete small win, not a teaser designed to withhold value.
- ◆ Give real value in your emails before you ever pitch — trust is what makes the offer land.
- ◆ A tightly scoped, fast-to-finish course beats a bloated one, both to build and to sell.

CHAPTER FIVE

The \$1,000/Month Math

Traffic, conversion, and the honest numbers

Vague promises don't build businesses — numbers do. Here is a conservative, realistic breakdown of what it actually takes to reach \$1,000/month from a Medium Vault funnel, using figures well within reach of a consistent beginner.

A Realistic Monthly Snapshot

Stage	Volume	Rate	Result
Vault articles live	8	—	—
Combined monthly views	4,000	—	—
Click to free resource	4,000	6%	240 clicks
Opt-in for free resource	240	55%	132 subscribers
Course purchase (nurture)	132	8%	~11 sales
Monthly revenue @ \$97/course			≈ \$1,067

Notice what's doing the heavy lifting: not viral traffic, not a huge audience — just eight modest, well-targeted articles and unglamorous conversion rates that are entirely achievable once your funnel is built correctly.

Three Levers, Not One

If you fall short of \$1,000, you only have three dials to turn, and you don't need to max out all three at once:

- ✓ **More articles** — each new vault entry adds its own stream of views without diluting the others.
- ✓ **Better conversion** — a stronger free resource or sharper email sequence lifts every number below it.
- ✓ **Higher price or upsell** — a \$67 core course with a \$47 add-on can reach the same target with fewer sales.

REALITY CHECK

These numbers assume articles that are genuinely well-written and correctly targeted — not eight rushed, generic posts. Quality is what makes the 6% and 55% realistic instead of wishful.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ \$1,000/month is achievable from roughly eight solid articles and a few thousand monthly views — not viral numbers.
- ◆ Every stage of the funnel has a conservative, well-tested benchmark conversion rate.
- ◆ You have three levers to hit your target: more articles, better conversion, or a higher-value offer.
- ◆ The math only works if the content and funnel quality genuinely earn those conversion rates.

Automating and Scaling the Vault

Turning a system into a habit that compounds

Once your first vault funnel is producing steady income, the goal shifts from "build" to "compound." This chapter covers how to remove yourself from the day-to-day running of the funnel, and how to grow past \$1,000 without a proportional increase in effort.

Automate the Repeatable Parts

- ✓ **Email delivery:** Set your nurture sequence and free-resource delivery to run automatically the moment someone subscribes — this should never require your manual attention.
- ✓ **Checkout and delivery:** Use a simple checkout link that automatically grants course access, so a 2 a.m. sale needs zero involvement from you.
- ✓ **Evergreen updates:** Revisit older vault articles every few months to refresh statistics, links, and examples — a ten-minute update can extend an article's earning life by another year.

Batch Your Writing

Instead of writing one article whenever inspiration strikes, set aside one or two focused sessions a month to draft several vault articles at once. Batching keeps your voice and structure consistent, and it means the vault keeps growing even during weeks you don't feel like writing at all.

Repurpose, Don't Reinvent

Every vault article can be sliced into a short LinkedIn post, a carousel, or a newsletter snippet — each pointing back to the original article. This multiplies your entry points without multiplying your workload.

CASE STUDY — FROM \$1,000 TO \$3,400

After hitting \$1,000/month with eight articles, a freelance copywriter kept publishing two new vault articles a month and refreshed her three oldest pieces. Fourteen months later, with eighteen total articles and the same course, her funnel was producing \$3,400/month — without a single new course being built.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ Automate email delivery and checkout so the funnel runs without your daily involvement.
- ◆ Refresh older vault articles periodically to extend their earning life.
- ◆ Batch-write new articles in focused sessions instead of relying on sporadic inspiration.
- ◆ Scaling past \$1,000/month is mostly about steady volume and upkeep, not reinventing the system.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

The 30-Day Vault Launch Checklist

A ready-to-use, week-by-week plan to get your first funnel live

Week 1 — Foundation

- ☐ Write your one-sentence promise: who you help, and the transformation you deliver.
- ☐ Choose the specific reader your first funnel will be built for.
- ☐ List 8–10 search phrases your ideal reader is likely typing into Google.
- ☐ Sketch the outline of your free resource (checklist, template, or mini-guide).

Week 2 — Build the Funnel Backend

- ☐ Create the free resource and design a simple opt-in landing page.
- ☐ Write a 4–6 email nurture sequence, ending with a clear course offer.
- ☐ Set up automated delivery for both the free resource and the emails.
- ☐ Set up a simple checkout link for your course or mini-course.

Week 3 — Write the First Vault Articles

- ☐ Draft your first three articles using the five-part structure from Chapter 3.
- ☐ Add one soft call-to-action per article, linking to your free resource.
- ☐ Publish the first article and submit it to relevant Medium publications or tags.
- ☐ Publish articles two and three, spaced a few days apart.

Week 4 — Publish, Track, Refine

- ☐ Publish two to three more articles to begin vault stacking.
- ☐ Track views, click-through rate, and opt-in rate for each article.
- ☐ Identify your best-performing headline or hook and apply that pattern going forward.
- ☐ Schedule your next batch-writing session for month two.

CONCLUSION

Build It Once, Let It Work

You now have the entire system: why Medium's built-in audience solves the cold-start problem no new blog can, how to position your vault around one specific promise, how to structure an article so it teaches and converts at the same time, how the funnel behind it turns curious readers into paying students, and the honest math that gets you to \$1,000 a month.

Nothing in this book requires a huge audience, a big budget, or luck. It requires eight well-built articles, a funnel that respects your reader's trust, and the patience to let a system compound instead of chasing a single viral moment. That's the real difference between people who make \$1,000 a month online and people who are still starting over every few weeks: the first group built a vault. The second group kept building sandcastles.

Start with one article. Write it well. Give it a real free resource to point to. Then write the second one. By the time you publish your eighth, you won't be hoping for \$1,000 a month — you'll be looking at the numbers that already got you there.

*"The best time to publish your first vault article
was six months ago.
The second best time is today."*





About The Profit Compass

The Profit Compass is a publishing brand dedicated to producing clear, practical playbooks on building real, sustainable income through content, digital products, and lean online systems — built for readers who want a working system, not hype.

The brand is founded and written by **Ujjawal Kumar**, who created The Profit Compass around a simple belief: most people don't need more information about making money online — they need one clear, honest system they can actually finish implementing. Every Profit Compass playbook, including this one, is built around that principle — a specific, achievable outcome, explained step by step, without the noise.

If *Medium Vault* helped you see a clear path to your first (or next) \$1,000 a month, the same content-to-cash principles apply well beyond Medium — to newsletters, YouTube, and any platform where an audience already exists, waiting for the right article to find them.